

Plant cards

Most cards are native (green badge); a few are non-native foils (rust badge, dashed edge) that look nice but feed pollinators poorly - spot them and limit them. The dark chips show bloom season and the visitors each feeds. Cover spring, summer, and fall, favor natives, and clump the same plant.

Serviceberry

Amelanchier canadensis

Native

BLOOMS

SPRINGSUMMERFALL

VISITED BY native bees, bumble bees, flies

One of the first trees to bloom each April.

Golden Alexanders

Zizia aurea

Native

BLOOMS

SPRINGSUMMERFALL

VISITED BY native bees, flies, beetles, butterflies

Tiny yellow flowers feed early short-tongued insects.

Eastern Redbud

Cercis canadensis

Native

BLOOMS

SPRINGSUMMERFALL

VISITED BY native bees, bumble bees, butterflies

Pink flowers on bare branches; early spring nectar and pollen for mason and bumble bees.

Butterfly Weed

Asclepias tuberosa

Native

BLOOMS

SPRINGSUMMERFALL

VISITED BY butterflies, native bees, hummingbirds

Orange milkweed and a monarch caterpillar host.

Wild Bergamot

Monarda fistulosa

Native

BLOOMS

SPRINGSUMMERFALL

VISITED BY bumble bees, butterflies, hummingbirds

Lavender tubes that long-tongued visitors love.

Black-eyed Susan

Rudbeckia hirta

Native

BLOOMS

SPRINGSUMMERFALL

VISITED BY native bees, butterflies, flies

Golden petals with a dark center; a summer classic.

Mountain Mint

Pycnanthemum tenuifolium

Native

BLOOMS

SPRINGSUMMERFALL

VISITED BY native bees, flies, butterflies, beetles

Flat white flowers draw a huge mix of insects.

Summersweet

Clethra alnifolia

Native

BLOOMS

SPRINGSUMMERFALL

VISITED BY bumble bees, butterflies, hummingbirds

Sweet-smelling white spikes for shady, wet spots.

Cardinal Flower

Lobelia cardinalis

Native

BLOOMS

SPRINGSUMMERFALL

VISITED BY hummingbirds, butterflies

Red tubes built for hummingbird beaks.

Joe-Pye Weed

Eutrochium purpureum

Native

BLOOMS

SPRINGSUMMERFALL

VISITED BY butterflies, native bees, bumble bees

Tall pink clouds buzzing in late summer.

New England Aster

Symphyotrichum novae-angliae

Native

BLOOMS

SPRINGSUMMERFALL

VISITED BY native bees, bumble bees, butterflies, flies

Purple fall blooms fuel migrating monarchs.

Goldenrod

Solidago rugosa

Native

BLOOMS

SPRINGSUMMERFALL

VISITED BY native bees, butterflies, flies, beetles

Yellow plumes blooming right up to frost.

Callery Pear

Pyrus calleryana

Invasive

BLOOMS

SPRING

SUMMER

FALL

VISITED BY a few early flies and bees;
little real value

*Showy white spring tree, but invasive
here and it crowds out native trees.*

Butterfly Bush

Buddleja davidii

Invasive

BLOOMS

SPRING

SUMMER

FALL

VISITED BY adult butterflies (nectar
only)

*Named for butterflies, but it feeds adults
only and no native caterpillar can eat it.*

Garden Mum

Chrysanthemum x morifolium

Non-native

BLOOMS

SPRING

SUMMER

FALL

VISITED BY few; double petals hide the
nectar and pollen

*Most fall pompom mums are double
cultivars whose petals block bees from
food.*

Pollinator cards

Each pollinator needs flowers in bloom across every season it is active. Match it to plants whose flower type fits (hummingbirds to red tubes, flies and beetles to flat open clusters, bees and butterflies to most flowers).

Native Bees

ACTIVE

SPRINGSUMMERFALL

VISITS Open daisy, mint, and clustered flowers with easy pollen.

Most are solitary and do not sting.

Bumble Bees

ACTIVE

SPRINGSUMMERFALL

VISITS Tube and hooded flowers like bergamot, reached with long tongues.

Queens wake first and need early spring blooms.

Butterflies and Monarchs

ACTIVE

SPRINGSUMMERFALL

VISITS Flat-topped clusters and big landing-pad flowers.

Monarchs fuel on fall asters before migrating.

Hummingbirds

ACTIVE

SPRINGSUMMERFALL

VISITS Red and pink tubular flowers full of nectar.

Long beaks reach where bees cannot.

Hoverflies and Flies

ACTIVE

SPRINGSUMMERFALL

VISITS Shallow open flowers like mountain mint.

Hoverflies copy bees but cannot sting.

Beetles

ACTIVE

SPRINGSUMMERFALL

VISITS Flat, sturdy flower clusters they can crawl across.

Some of Earth's oldest pollinators.

Grid board

Place your plant cards in the season they bloom (a plant that blooms twice can sit in two columns). Keep something in every column, and clump the same plant together.

SPRING	SUMMER	FALL

Pollinator food check

Tick a box only if a plant in that season feeds this pollinator. Every pollinator should have a tick in each season it is active.

POLLINATOR	SPRING	SUMMER	FALL
Native Bees			
Bumble Bees			
Butterflies and Monarchs			
Hummingbirds			
Hoverflies and Flies			
Beetles			